

System Management

6.1 Clean up the system

Cleaning up the system involves maintenance tasks such as deleting temporary files, downloaded internet files, recycle bin, redundant registry entries and other tasks that free up memory and generally keep the system healthy. It can actually be compared to spring cleaning your living environment, thereby your work flow gets streamlined and efficiency increases.

CCleaner (formerly Crap Cleaner) is a freeware system optimisation tool that serves this function. It removes unused and temporary files from your system. This makes Windows run smoother, faster and more in a more efficient manner. The bonus is that you get more hard disk space. The software is able to go inside other applications and clean unnecessary information that the application has stored over time. For instance with web browsers such as IE and Firefox, it can clear cache, history and cookies. Its repertoire has several applications with which it is compatible. CCleaner is also able to clean unused and old entries from the registry. This greatly reduces the startup time since Windows has a smaller registry to go through at startup. There is also an in-built uninstaller.

The interface is pretty simple to understand. On the left panel you have icons for the various functions that CCleaner offers viz. Cleaner, Registry, Tools. There is also an options button.

6.1.1 Cleaner

The cleaner function has two tabs. One is for clean up related to Windows and the other is clean up related to applications. By default, there are some options selected in both the tabs. It's best to leave them that way unless you are an advanced user. There are two action buttons available. Analyse and Run Cleaner. When you are on either of the tabs you should click Analyse before actually executing the cleaning process. It is